KIRINYAGA UNIVERTSITY ST. THOMAS AQUINAS

CATHOLIC STUDENTS' ASSOCIATION CHOIR

THE CONSTITUTION

Thomas Aquinas choir

KYU CSA



ST. THOMAS AQUINAS CHOIR CONSTITUTION

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CHAPTER ONE: NAME, MISSION, VISION AND OBJECTIVES

ARTICLE 1: NAME

This is a group under Kirinyaga University Catholic Church fraternity and therefore named as **ST. THOMAS AQUINAS CHOIR.**

ARTICLE 2: MISSION AND VISION

MISSION: Achieving greater heights spiritually in catholic faith through prayer and singing as an instrument of hope to human.

VISSION: To enhance spiritual maturity among students in a bid to help them spread the gospel throughout the world.

ARTICLE 3: OBJECTIVES

Section I: Objectives Pedagogy

1. To promote unity amongst the church members by coming together for a single purpose,
2. To nurture the Christian faith and experience in one's commitment and try to communicate this faith to the congregation milieu by bearing witness to Jesus Christ through singing.
3. To create a joyous environment, which helps members to integrate their efforts to serve Christ.
4. To foster spiritual growth and development to strengthen catholic faith.

Section II: Methodology

Under the above objectives, St. Thomas Aquinas choir will try to:

1. Participate in activities organized by the Catholic Church in Kenya.
2. Join the entire congregation during prayers and portray a good example to the church members.
3. Communicate effectively with other church choirs to reflect on joint action with a view of meeting objectives which are common for all.
4. Promote guidelines for action to be carried out by members in solidarity with the church.
5. Sing during mass with an aim of spreading the gospel.

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CHAPTER TWO: MEMBERSHIP AND WITHDRAWALS FROM MEMBERSHIP

ARTICLE 1: MEMBERSHIP AND WITHDRAWAL

1. St. Thomas Aquinas choir members will be drawn from the church members or congregation.
2. One becomes a member on payment of a membership fee of **Ksh. 20** and renewal fee of **Ksh. 20** for every semester though liable to changes from time to time. This amount is **non-refundable.**
3. Members should be of the same objectives and goals as stipulated in this constitution.
4. Any choir member who defaults registration requirements will:
    a) Not be recognized as a legitimate member.
    b) Not entitled to any benefits from the choir account.
5. New members will be given a probation period of Two(2) months upon joining the choir.

CHAPTER THREE: FINANCE

ARTICLE 1: SOURCE OF FUNDING

1. Registration and renewal fee by members.
2. Fund raising through Harambee.
3. Donations by well-wishers.
4. Project income.

ARTICLE 2: ACCOUNT

SECTION 1: ACCOUNT AND MINIMUM ACCOUNT BALANCE

St. Thomas Aquinas choir has **NO** bank account thus operates under Kirinyaga University Catholic Students' Association (CSA) bank account, maintaining independent books of account.

This section provides that there should be a clear description of how finances have been spent against the due dates.

The minimum amount set for the account of the movement is maintained at Ksh. 2000.

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CHAPTER FOUR: COMMITTEE MEMBERS

ARTICLE 1: ELECTED MEMBERS

SECTION 1. EXECUTIVE

These will be termed as the executive and they include:

- Chairperson
- Vice chairperson
- Secretary
- Assistant secretary
- Treasurer

SECTION 2: MEMBERS

These will be termed as members of the committee and they include:

- Choir master/ mistress and their assistants
- Instrument keepers
- Gender representatives
- Project manager
- Patron

NB:

1. Patron will not be elected. Parish Priest will automatically be the Patron.
2. There will be sub-committee known as Discipline advisory committee.

ARTICLE 2: DUTIES OF EXECUTIVE AND MEMBERS

SECTION 1: EXECUTIVE

a) Chairperson

1. Chairs all the group meetings both executive and general.
2. Together with members, he/she should strive to come up with new ideas to build and improve the organization.

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3. Presenting the interest of the choir to the church committee/ congregation.
4. Will assign duties to members.

b) Vice chairperson

1. Will assist the chairperson in his/her duties and any other duties as maybe assigned.
2. Assuming the roles of chairperson in his/her absentia.
3. Presenting the interest of the choir to the church committee.
4. Ensuring implementation of rules made or agreed upon.
5. He/she chairs all disciplinary committee meetings.

c) Secretary

1. Will keep records of all choir assets and deal with all correspondence.
2. Issuing notices and agenda of all executive and general meetings.
3. Taking minutes during executive and general meetings.
4. Will take roll calls.
5. Will prepare a report before the end of the year elaborating various activities carried out during the year, challenges faced and general status of the office.
6. He/she is the custodian of the group's constitution.

d) Assistant Secretary

1. He/she will assist the secretary in the above stipulated duties.
2. Assumes all roles of the secretary in absentia.

e) Treasurer

1. Will keep the accounting records of St. Thomas Aquinas choir.
2. Will give full financial statements of the choir at the end of the semester or on request by the members.
3. Will prepare budget proposal for choir activities.
4. Will conduct payments and receipt will approval from the executive committee.
5. Will be responsible for any mismanagement of choir funds.

SECTION 2: DUTIES OF COMMITTEE MEMBERS

i. Choir master/mistress

1. Will conduct the choir practices and lead the choir during mass.
2. Will prepare the program of songs liturgically.

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3. Will co-ordinate with the priest in order to make the choir aware of the songs to be sung during mass or liturgical occasions.
4. Will lias with those in charge of all music festivals.
5. Will be the choir representative to all music meetings.

ii. Assistant Choir Master/Mistress

1. Will assist the choir master/mistress in all his/her duties.
2. He/she will be the time keep in choir.
3. Assume all the roles of choir master/mistress in absentia.

iii. Instruments keeper

1. Will keep the instruments and ensure good care of Kayambas, drums, hymn books and any other church choir instruments.
2. Will avail instruments during choir practices and mass in time.
3. Will give reports on the condition of the instruments to the committee on regular basis.

iv. Gender representatives

1. Solving minor differences arising from the particular gender.
2. Forwarding to the committee any voice problems or grievances which may need more attention.

v. Project manager

1. He/she will be in charge of choir projects.
2. Giving reports in projects assigning duties to members in respect to choir project.

vi. The Patron

1. He will advise the choir, give guidelines and be the symbol of solidarity.
2. The patron will so be contacted and made aware of any plans of actions.

vii. Disciplinary advisory committee

The committee will consist of:

a) Vice chairperson
b) Chairperson
c) Choir master

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d) Voice representatives
e) Two (2) ordinary choir members.

They will be responsible for ensuring that the code of conduct is adhered to, as stipulated in this constitution.

NB: The committee must give equal attention to the matters affecting any members of the choir.

CHAPTER FIVE: ELECTION AND HANDING OVER

ARTICLE 1: ELECTIONS TO AND WITHDRAWAL FROM OFFICE

1. On completion of the term of office i.e., 1 year, the officials decide and announce a date of elections and all seats declared vacant. The elections are held democratically. This is done at the beginning of the 2nd semester of every academic year.
2. The Chairperson, the secretary and the project manager positions shall not be filled by members who are in their first and last academic year.
3. The position of the treasurer is not eligible to the members who are in their last academic year **EXCEPT** when there are no active registered members who can take up the role hence third years may be considered eligible for the position.
4. Members will suggest nominees for various posts, if nominee agrees to contest whether present or absent members will vote by show of hands. The returning officers will count the votes and announce the winners. Elections of each post are done in returns. No open campaign will be carried out.
5. If complains are raised by members or contestants and genuine irregularities are noted the elections of that particular post will be nullifies and fresh elections held.
6. Only members are entitled to vote and hold position in the office or any other committee position.
7. Members have the right to call for elections whenever they feel necessary even before the end of the year/term, but it must be approved by three quarters of the members.
8. Resignation by the official with a valid reason on why to do so.
9. Failure to attend four consecutive official meetings without an apology.
10. Using the position that one holds for personal interest.

ARTICLE 2: HANDING OVER

The former officials hold a joint meeting with the newly elected officials to enable the handing over of the books and any other property they were holding that belongs to the choir.

Handing over is supposed to be done during the first meeting after election.

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CHAPTER SIX: PRACTICES, CODE OF CONDUCT AND CODE OF DRESSING

ARTICLE 1: PRACTICES

1. The choir practices will be held on Tuesdays from 6:00pm to 8:00pm and on Saturdays from 1:00pm to 4:00pm. Other days of practice will be fixed within the next week when need arises.
2. During practice sessions, the choir will practice for mass and learn new songs and prepare for other occasions.
3. All choir rehearsals for the respective days i.e., Tuesdays and Saturdays should end 5 minutes before the end time allocations.
4. The 1st one hour will strictly be used for common songs rehearsals and mass program preparations/warm ups.

   NB: Voice separations will be determined by the turn up quorum and when the need to give an attention to an occasion arises, voice separation won't hold.
5. The choir parts/voices should [if they have to separate] for a maximum of 1 ½ hrs.
   i. Each song should take a maximum of 30 minutes [per voice] 1.e simple, short liturgical songs with short sentence structures.

   NOTE: Complex, meditating/reflective/educative/occasional and other related songs should not hold to this rule.

ii) The voices should recombine and perfect the newly trained songs for 30mins [maximum].

NOTE: Trainers shall choose who to conduct the joint training in accordance to their allocations [only one trainer at a time].

6. Each trainer [regardless of whether you are training that piece or not] should have the copies of the songs to be trained before the practice time.

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7. New songs to be trained will be send 3 or 4 days prior to the practice day in the trainers group.
8. Ignorance and common-sense mistakes which may also be associated with music notations, solfege will force a trainer to go for a "rehearsal break". i.e., No training the next rehearsal – [whole week break in that case].

   NOTE: The rule applies heavily to anyone who encounters such difficulties and never seeks for assistance.
9. For any trainer who is not training in that moment, they should join others to their respective voices and get trained with others.

   NOTE: No pitching, no correcting of the trainer as he/she is training unless they call for assistance. **[OPT FOR A SIDE MEETING WITH THE TRAINER FOR HUMBLE CORRECTION AND GENEROUS ACCEPTANCE].**
10. Any trainer found intimidating, condemning, isolating or discussing substandard issues with members/public will be summoned and forced for a break too.
11. Every mass should have at least two directors and a maximum of three for an equal chance.
12. Where piano accompaniment is required/used, a minimum of two pianists should be allocated programs and be prepared in advance.

    NOTE: At most two songs [new] should be taught in a single practice session though this is subject to changes.

ARTICLE 2. CODE OF CONDUCT

1. Any member attending practice must be sober.
2. All members will be required to attend practice frequently and incase of commitments seek permission from the choir master/mistress or send a message to choir members.

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3. Members will be kindly required to strive to know each other and grow in love as a family.
4. The group will not be liable to members or individuals out of its jurisdiction.
5. All members will be required to uphold high standards of discipline and responsibility.

Under this code, the following is considered in the practice room;

a) Chewing gums.
b) Walking out without permission from choir master.
c) Unnecessary movements.
d) Reading articles.
e) Unnecessary communication.
f) Contradicting choir master/mistress on liturgical songs.
g) All phones will be on silent mode or vibration during choir practice.

6. Members who fail to attend Sunday morning practice session at 7.05 am unless stated otherwise will not join the rest during mass though they may avail themselves after the mass for practice if any.
7. Ladies and gentlemen will alternate to arrange seats in practice room.
8. Any decision toward suspension/expulsion of a member will come from the committee.
9. Members who need to leave for the day or briefly must strictly seek permission from the choir master.
10. Members who fail to attend four (4) consecutive practices will be warned three times after which they will cease to be choir members.
11. Only registered members and those who adhere to the above regulations will be recognized as choir members.
12. Two (2) month's absenteeism from choir without prior apology will lead to disqualification from the choir. To rejoin the choir the member will apply through the committee.

ARTICLE 3: CODE OF DRESSING

Uniforms will be worn on the 3rd Sunday and any member who doesn't wear the approved uniform will not be allowed to join the choir members in the church during mass but can join them later after mass.

a) All choir members will dress decently whenever they are in the precincts of the church to reflect a dignified presentation.
b) Choir members will be in uniform whenever attending liturgical ceremonies or any other ceremonies as may be advised.
c) Ladies will never wear miniskirts or revealing clothes on Sunday's worship and men will be smartly dressed, no sagging is allowed.

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CHAPTER SEVEN: WELFARE

Funeral ceremonies:

a) All the choir members will attend the burial ceremony of a deceased choir member at their own transport cost.
b) The grieved family will be comforted with at least Ksh. 2,000.00
c) Every member will be required to contribute towards the above
d) Should a choir member lose a relative within immediate family.
    i. A child
    ii. A parent
    iii. Wife/Husband
    iv. Brother/Sister

CHAPTER EIGHT: AMENDMENTS OF THE CONSTITUTION

1. Any member of the choir can propose amendments af the constitution and a special committee will review the proposal and report to the members who can either approve or reject the amendments by voting.
2. Amendments will sail through with a vote of three quarters of total members.

CHAPTER NINE: DISSOLUTION OF THE ASSOCIATION

Dissolution of St, Thomas Aquinas choir can only be effective under two conditions namely:

i. The Kirinyaga University Catholic Student's Association decision not to have the group.
ii. Non-existence of Kirinyaga University Catholic Student's Association.

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CHAPTER TEN: APPROVAL

THESE TERMS AND CONDITIONS HAVE BEEN DISCUSSED AND APPROVED BY ALL MEMBERS IN THE COMMITTEE MEETING OF THE GROUP HELD ON 17/3/2022 BY PUTTING THEIR SIGNATURES ASSENT.

Signed by:

NAME	POSITION	SIGNATURE
1. SAMUEL MWAURA	CHAIRPERSON	.....
2. FELISTUS MUENI	SECRETARY	.....
3. VINCENT KARANJA	TREASURER	.....

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